PAVEL CHERKASHIN

Global Head of Education GTM • Institutional AI Licensing • Operator • Investor • Educator

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Executive Thesis: *"Scaling OpenAI's education footprint from departmental pilots to pervasive campus and nationwide deployments. Rare combination of enterprise licensing executive (negotiated Adobe's largest global education transaction in corporate history: 1.5M+ Adobe CS licenses across national systems), venture investor ($100M+ deployed in frontier technology), and published university textbook author. Architecting high-velocity GTM systems, partner ecosystems, and sales teams that empower millions of students and educators while maintaining rigorous data privacy and governance."*

STRATEGIC FOCUS: GLOBAL EDUCATION GTM SYSTEM & TEAM LEADERSHIP

Education is OpenAI's most transformative enterprise frontier: converting universities, community colleges, and national ministries from cautious observers into campus-wide AI adopters. Sustainable education GTM requires solving complex institutional hurdles: procurement bureaucracy, strict data privacy standards (FERPA, GDPR, COPPA), administrative cost pressures, and faculty pedagogical alignment. Having scaled technology businesses as an operator, evaluated market economics as a venture capitalist, and taught in university lecture halls as a textbook author, I design GTM engines that pair consultative high-touch sales with automated campus enablement—positioning ChatGPT Edu as the indispensable cognitive infrastructure for learning and research.

THE 6-MONTH EDUCATION GTM ACCELERATION ARC (OPERATIONAL MILESTONES)

Months 1–2 **Lighthouses & Packaging**	**Enterprise Education Packaging & Flagship Lighthouses:** Establish standardized, tiered commercial agreements for ChatGPT Edu (departmental, campus-wide, and research supercomputing tiers). Close initial lighthouse deals with top-tier research universities. Publish institutional governance playbooks addressing student data privacy, academic integrity, and FERPA compliance.
Months 3–4 **National & Ministry Scale**	**Statewide & Ministry Agreements (Adobe Deal Blueprint):** Replicate the 1.5M+ seat licensing model across state university systems and international ministries of education. Build a world-class education sales, solutions engineering, and customer success motion. Deploy education-specialized channel partners and systems integrators to accelerate institutional onboarding.
Months 5–6 **Curriculum & Telemetry Loops**	**Autonomous Onboarding & Academic Research Loops:** Implement automated administrative provisioning pipelines for 100k+ student campuses. Synthesize educator usage telemetry directly into OpenAI product roadmaps. Launch OpenAI Education Advisory Board connecting leading academic deans with OpenAI research leadership.

CORE EDUCATION GTM & INSTITUTIONAL CAPABILITIES

- **Mega-Scale Enterprise Licensing:** Proven record closing 7- and 8-figure institutional agreements, multi-campus deployments, and government-backed educational frameworks.
- **Pedagogical Innovation & Academic Authority:** Published university textbook author with firsthand insight into curriculum design, faculty resistance, and student adoption dynamics.
- **Campus AI Governance & Compliance:** Deep command of student privacy (FERPA, GDPR, COPPA), enterprise security standards, data segregation, and AI safety protocols.
- **GTM Systems & Autonomous Telemetry:** Architect of AI-native sales automation pipelines, automated license provisioning, and high-retention customer success systems.

SELECTED CAREER TRACK RECORD & INSTITUTIONAL LEADERSHIP

Regional Director & Enterprise Licensing Executive — *Adobe Systems / Enterprise Operations*

- **Adobe Landmark Global Deal:** Spearheaded, negotiated, and closed the **largest global education transaction in Adobe's corporate history**, deploying **1.5M+ Adobe Creative Suite licenses** across regional academic networks and education ministries. Built the end-to-end institutional procurement framework, multi-tier reseller ecosystem, and teacher enablement programs.

Managing Partner & Ecosystem Architect — *Mindrock Capital / Vestor.In* (2016–Present)

- Directed enterprise technology investments and deployed $100M+ into frontier AI, compute infrastructure, and developer platforms. Built autonomous agent systems automating enterprise sales workflows, partner intake, and data telemetry.

Author & University Educator — *Venture Capital & Entrepreneurship University Textbook*

- Authored authoritative, widely adopted university textbook used across business schools and computer science faculties. Designed experiential case pedagogy bridging frontier technology commercialization with academic curriculum.

Global Accelerator Lead & Mentor — *Founder Institute Alumnus (2014) & Decile Start Fund*

- Evaluated and mentored 5,000+ university founders, researchers, and students. Established global university incubator pipelines connecting international academic talent with Silicon Valley capital and research ecosystems.

EDUCATION, GLOBAL ECOSYSTEMS & CREDENTIALS

- **Quantitative Foundation & Systems:** Applied Mathematics & Computer Science, Russian State University of Oil & Gas.
  - **Global Network & Accelerator:** Founder Institute Silicon Valley Alumnus (2014); established relationships across US, European, and Asian universities.
  - **Languages & Cross-Cultural Reach:** Fluent English, native Russian; seasoned executive in cross-border institutional diplomacy.